

4. Wireshark

(<https://wireshark.org>)

Another free, open-source software, it specializes in being able to analyze network traffic in real time. Its USP being its sniffing technology, Wireshark is popular for its ability to scan through and detect security problems in any network and hence, its effectiveness in solving general network routing problems.

Its main features include:

- Support for offline inspection through analyses that are saved
- Packet browser (package based, inspired from Linux based package managers)
- Feature-rich graphical user interface
- Well-documented VoIP analysis
- Inspection and decompression of .gzip/.zip/.tar files
- Reads and supports other file formats, including Sniffer Pro, tcpdump (libpcap), Microsoft network monitor, Cisco Secure IDS iplog, etc.
- Supports a wide variety of ports and network devices: Ethernet, IEEE 802.11, PPP/HDLC, ATM, Bluetooth, USB, Token Ring, Frame Relay, FDDI.
- Protocol decryption includes but not limited to IPsec, ISAKMP, Kerberos, SNMPv3, SSL/TLS, WEP, WPA/WPA2 and other endemic protocols as well
- Can export results to XML, PostScript, CSV, or plain text with options of a high degree of customizability

Available Platforms: With support for over 2000+ different network protocols, its available on all major operating systems including Linux, Windows, Mac OS X, FreeBSD, NetBSD, OpenBSD



5. OpenVAS

(www.tenable.org)

Previously popular as the much loved “Nessus”, it is an open-sourced network scanner used



to detect vulnerabilities in remote hosts. One of the more efficient network vulnerability scanners, it has remained very popular among DevOps, system administrators, Tech collaborators.